Ethics, Death & Organ Donation – Section Summary

Brain death • Apnoea test • Capacity • Double effect

Critical Care Board Review • Section 1 • MCQ-Oriented

1. Key Points

- Brain death mimic → **locked-in syndrome** (contraindication to proceeding)
- Brainstem reflexes: pupils, corneal, **oculocephalic**, oculovestibular, cough/gag
- Cannot complete exam (e.g. cranial nerve palsy) → **ancillary test** (EEG/perfusion)
- Refusal of care → first **assess capacity/mental status**
- Morphine for comfort → **doctrine of double effect**

2. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- [x] Locked-in can mimic brain death
- [x] Incomplete exam → ancillary test

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